APPSC Micro Tricks

Which answer trick works **in which subject, which kind of question, which syllabus unit and which topic** - measured on the Commission's own keys. A trick that shows "no signal" across the whole paper can be strong inside one corner of it and useless or even wrong in another; this book gives each corner its own rules.

> **How to read the tables. key** = how often the trick's pick was the official answer there; **chance** = what blind guessing gives; **count** = hits / questions where the trick applied. **trust**: **solid** = could hardly be luck ($p < 0.01$); **likely** = $p < 0.05$, or a weaker result that the same corner of UPSC / other state papers repeats (✓); hint = suggestive only. A **reverse trick** is an option kind that is rarely the key there - strike it first.
> **Rule of use:** facts first; tricks only to choose between options you could not eliminate. With 1/3 negative marking, guess only after striking at least one option.

1. Rules that hold across the whole APPSC paper

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick 'Both'.	**54%**	41%	66/122	**solid**
Pick the option that shares most words with the other three - decoys are made by changing one part of the key.	**35%**	25%	49/140	**solid**
Pick 'All of the above'.	**44%**	25%	15/34	**solid**
Pick the only option carrying a number or date.	**34%**	25%	34/100	**likely**
Pick the one option that shares no word with the other three.	**30%**	25%	79/261	**likely**

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **the smallest number**	**16%**	25%	58/366	**solid**
Strike **'None of the above'**	**7%**	25%	3/41	**solid**
Strike **'Neither ... nor'**	**13%**	25%	5/39	hint

2. By kind of question (all subjects)

NOT / INCORRECT / EXCEPT (279 APPSC questions)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 4** - the key sits here more than its share.	**35%**	25%	97/279	**solid** ✓
Pick the only option carrying a number or date.	**46%**	25%	10/22	**likely** ✓

Statements (consider the following) (192 APPSC questions)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick 'Both'.	**54%**	36%	13/24	**likely** ✓

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **one of two near-twin options (the twins are a trap here)**	**32%**	50%	7/22	hint

Match / pairs (43 APPSC questions)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 2** - the key sits here more than its share.	**35%**	25%	15/43	**likely** ✓

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **option 4**	**14%**	25%	6/43	hint

Assertion-Reason (48 APPSC questions)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 1** - the key sits here more than its share.	**46%**	25%	22/48	**solid** ✓
Pick 'Both'.	**72%**	54%	33/46	**likely** ✓
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**35%**	25%	17/48	hint
When two options are almost the same (one word differs), the key is one of those two - drop the other two.	**75%**	50%	9/12	hint

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **option 4**	**4%**	25%	2/48	**solid** ✓

Order / sequence (30 APPSC questions)

No trick beats chance here - rely on the fact.

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **option 4**	**10%**	25%	3/30	**likely** ✓

Who (person) (466 APPSC questions)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**32%**	25%	132/410	**solid** ✓

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **echo option (repeats the question's words)**	**0%**	25%	0/15	**likely** ✓

When (year / date / period) (217 APPSC questions)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Among four numbers, keep the 2nd and 3rd largest; drop the extremes.	**64%**	50%	37/58	**likely**
Pick the clearly shortest option.	**35%**	25%	25/71	**likely**

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **the smallest number**	**16%**	25%	9/58	**likely** ✓

Where (place / location) (229 APPSC questions)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 3** - the key sits here more than its share.	**30%**	25%	69/229	**likely**

How much (number / % / rank) (131 APPSC questions)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 1** - the key sits here more than its share.	**32%**	25%	42/131	**likely**

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **the smallest number**	**11%**	25%	8/75	**solid** ✓

Scheme / policy / programme (151 APPSC questions)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**34%**	25%	38/110	**likely**
Between two survivors, prefer **option 2** - the key sits here more than its share.	**30%**	25%	46/151	**likely** ✓

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **option 4**	**17%**	25%	25/151	**likely** ✓

Article / Act / Amendment / Section (116 APPSC questions)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Among four numbers, keep the 2nd and 3rd largest; drop the extremes.	**67%**	50%	29/43	**likely**

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **the smallest number**	**12%**	25%	5/43	**likely** ✓

Definition / term / known as (111 APPSC questions)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the option that shares most words with the other three - decoys are made by changing one part of the key.	**69%**	25%	9/13	**solid** ✓
Between two survivors, prefer **option 1** - the key sits here more than its share.	**32%**	25%	35/111	hint

Superlative (first / largest / highest) (192 APPSC questions)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**35%**	25%	51/144	**solid**
Between two survivors, prefer **option 2** - the key sits here more than its share.	**31%**	25%	60/192	**likely**

Which / what (other direct fact) (1312 APPSC questions)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the option that repeats the question's own words.	**32%**	25%	35/108	**likely**

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **'None of the above'**	**0%**	25%	0/18	**likely** ✓
Strike **the smallest number**	**19%**	25%	18/96	**likely** ✓

3. History & Culture (1151 keyed APPSC questions)

Across the subject

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**31%**	25%	294/947	**solid**

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **'None of the above'**	**0%**	25%	0/16	**likely** ✓
Strike **the smallest number**	**10%**	25%	3/30	**likely** ✓

Statements (consider the following) questions (33)

No trick beats chance here - rely on the fact.

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **shortest option**	**5%**	25%	1/21	**likely**

Match / pairs questions (15)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 2** - the key sits here more than its share.	**47%**	25%	7/15	**likely** ✓

Who (person) questions (391)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**33%**	25%	115/348	**solid** ✓
Between two survivors, prefer **option 1** - the key sits here more than its share.	**30%**	25%	118/391	**likely**

When (year / date / period) questions (61)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 3** - the key sits here more than its share.	**36%**	25%	22/61	**likely**

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **the smallest number**	**6%**	25%	1/18	**likely** ✓

Where (place / location) questions (74)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 3** - the key sits here more than its share.	**34%**	25%	25/74	**likely** ✓

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **option 1**	**18%**	25%	13/74	hint

Superlative (first / largest / highest) questions (56)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 2** - the key sits here more than its share.	**34%**	25%	19/56	**likely** ✓

Which / what (other direct fact) questions (423)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**31%**	25%	117/373	**solid ✓**
When two options are almost the same (one word differs), the key is one of those two - drop the other two.	**71%**	50%	15/21	**likely**

Unit by unit (syllabus units)

Delhi Sultanate, Vijayanagara Empire, Mughal Empire, Bhakti Movement and Sufism - Administration, Economy, Society, Religion, Literature, Arts and Architecture (195)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**33%**	25%	54/163	**likely**

Indian War of Independence 1857; Religious and Social Reform Movements of the 19th Century; India's Freedom Movement; Revolutionaries in India and Abroad (236)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**37%**	25%	70/190	**solid**

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **shortest option**	**16%**	25%	29/183	**solid**

Indus Valley Civilization, Vedic Age, Mahajanapadas, Jainism & Buddhism, Magadha, Mauryas, Foreign Invasions, Kushanas, Satavahanas, Sangam Age, Sungas, Gupta Empire (207)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 2** - the key sits here more than its share.	**30%**	25%	62/207	hint

Kanauj and their Contributions; South Indian Dynasties - Badami Chalukyas, Eastern Chalukyas, Rashtrakutas, Kalyani Chalukyas, Cholas, Hoysalas, Yadavas, Kakatiyas, Reddis (199)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 2** - the key sits here more than its share.	**31%**	25%	61/199	**likely**
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**31%**	25%	55/178	**likely**

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **option 4**	**17%**	25%	34/199	**solid**
Strike **echo option (repeats the question's words)**	**0%**	25%	0/12	**likely**

Mahatma Gandhi - Thoughts, Principles, Philosophy and Satyagrahas; Sardar Patel and Subhas Chandra Bose; Dr. B.R. Ambedkar; India after Independence and Reorganisation of States (227)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 2** - the key sits here more than its share.	**31%**	25%	71/227	**likely**
Among four numbers, keep the 2nd and 3rd largest; drop the extremes.	**71%**	50%	12/17	hint

Micro-topics with a pattern of their own

Satavahanas - origin debate, Simuka, Gautamiputra Satakarni, Nasik Prasasti, Vasishthiputra Pulumavi (29)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 2** - the key sits here more than its share.	**45%**	25%	13/29	**likely**

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **option 1**	**7%**	25%	2/29	**likely**

Reddi kingdoms of Addanki, Kondavidu and Rajahmundry - Prolaya Vema Reddi, Kumaragiri Reddi (28)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**42%**	25%	11/26	**likely**

Telugu language and literature to the 14th century - Nannaya, Tikkana, Errana, Palkuriki Somanatha (32)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 1** - the key sits here more than its share.	**38%**	25%	12/32	hint

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **shortest option**	**9%**	25%	2/22	hint
Strike **option 4**	**12%**	25%	4/32	hint

Social and religious reform in Andhra - Kandukuri Veeresalingam, Gurajada Apparao, Raghupathi Venkataratnam Naidu (45)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**39%**	25%	16/41	**likely**

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **shortest option**	**5%**	25%	2/39	**solid**

Andhra in the freedom movement - Alluri Sitarama Raju and the Rampa Rebellion, Duggirala Gopalakrishnayya (29)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**52%**	25%	12/23	**solid**
Between two survivors, prefer **option 1** - the key sits here more than its share.	**45%**	25%	13/29	**likely**

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **shortest option**	**4%**	25%	1/22	**likely**

Linguistic reorganisation demand; Potti Sriramulu's fast and the formation of Andhra State 1953 (47)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 2** - the key sits here more than its share.	**38%**	25%	18/47	**likely**
Pick the clearly shortest option.	**38%**	25%	13/34	hint

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **longest option**	**12%**	25%	5/41	**likely**
Strike **option 1**	**15%**	25%	7/47	hint

Formation of Andhra Pradesh 1956 - Visalandhra, Gentlemen's Agreement (42)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 1** - the key sits here more than its share.	**38%**	25%	16/42	**likely**

Keywords inside statements (any statement here is true 53%)

statement contains	true	count	read it as
recently / launched	11%	1/9	**suspect FALSE**
all	31%	4/13	**suspect FALSE**
not	37%	7/19	**suspect FALSE**
a number (figure, year, %)	61%	51/84	no signal
first	61%	14/23	no signal
Andhra / AP	67%	12/18	**suspect TRUE**

4. Polity, Governance & Society (415 keyed APPSC questions)

Across the subject

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 1** - the key sits here more than its share.	**31%**	25%	127/415	**solid**
Pick 'Both'.	**68%**	41%	15/22	**solid** ✓
Pick the one option that shares no word with the other three.	**43%**	25%	16/37	**solid**
Pick the option that repeats the question's own words.	**40%**	25%	20/50	**likely** ✓
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**30%**	25%	88/293	**likely** ✓
Pick the only option carrying a number or date.	**47%**	25%	7/15	hint
Pick the largest number.	**34%**	25%	23/67	hint

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **the smallest number**	**12%**	25%	8/67	**likely** ✓

When (year / date / period) questions (22)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the latest year.	**46%**	25%	6/13	hint

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **option 4**	**9%**	25%	2/22	**likely** ✓

Scheme / policy / programme questions (45)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**41%**	25%	13/32	**likely**
Between two survivors, prefer **option 2** - the key sits here more than its share.	**38%**	25%	17/45	**likely**

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **option 4**	**13%**	25%	6/45	**likely** ✓

Article / Act / Amendment / Section questions (71)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Among four numbers, keep the 2nd and 3rd largest; drop the extremes.	**72%**	50%	21/29	**likely**

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **the smallest number**	**10%**	25%	3/29	**likely** ✓

Which / what (other direct fact) questions (102)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the largest number.	**80%**	25%	8/10	**solid**
Pick the option that repeats the question's own words.	**53%**	25%	8/15	**likely** ✓
Between two survivors, prefer **option 1** - the key sits here more than its share.	**34%**	25%	35/102	**likely**

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **option 4**	**17%**	25%	17/102	**likely**
Strike **middle numbers**	**20%**	50%	2/10	hint
Strike **the smallest number**	**0%**	25%	0/10	**likely** ✓

Unit by unit (syllabus units)

Constitutional Authorities - Powers, Functions and Responsibilities; Panchayati Raj; Public Policy and Governance (84)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 2** - the key sits here more than its share.	**36%**	25%	30/84	**likely**

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **option 4**	**13%**	25%	11/84	**solid**

Functions and Responsibilities of the Union and States; Parliament and State Legislatures; Federal Structure, Devolution of Powers and Finances up to Local Levels (137)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the one option that shares no word with the other three.	**53%**	25%	8/15	**likely**
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**34%**	25%	32/95	**likely**
Among four numbers, keep the 2nd and 3rd largest; drop the extremes.	**69%**	50%	18/26	**likely**
Pick the option that repeats the question's own words.	**44%**	25%	7/16	hint

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **the smallest number**	**0%**	25%	0/26	**solid**
Strike **shortest option**	**16%**	25%	15/91	**likely**

India's Foreign Policy and International Relations; Important Institutions, Agencies and Fora; Important Policies and Programmes of Central and State Governments (60)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the largest number.	**50%**	25%	7/14	**likely**
Between two survivors, prefer **option 1** - the key sits here more than its share.	**33%**	25%	20/60	hint

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **middle numbers**	**21%**	50%	3/14	**likely**

Rights Issues - Human Rights, Women's Rights, SC/ST Rights, Child Rights (50)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 1** - the key sits here more than its share.	**34%**	25%	17/50	hint

Keywords inside statements (any statement here is true 48%)

statement contains	true	count	read it as
all	30%	10/33	**suspect FALSE**
recently / launched	33%	4/12	**suspect FALSE**
cannot / can not	36%	4/11	**suspect FALSE**
not	37%	22/59	**suspect FALSE**
any	41%	11/27	no signal
may / can	43%	33/76	no signal
a number (figure, year, %)	47%	54/116	no signal
first	50%	7/14	no signal
every	50%	5/10	no signal
only	53%	18/34	no signal
Article / Section	56%	37/66	no signal

5. Economy (India & AP) (494 keyed APPSC questions)

Across the subject

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**32%**	25%	108/336	**solid**
Pick 'Both'.	**76%**	40%	13/17	**solid** ✓
Pick the option that shares most words with the other three - decoys are made by changing one part of the key.	**43%**	25%	16/37	**solid** ✓

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **one of two near-twin options (the twins are a trap here)**	**29%**	50%	10/34	**likely**

NOT / INCORRECT / EXCEPT questions (42)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 4** - the key sits here more than its share.	**40%**	25%	17/42	**likely** ✓

Statements (consider the following) questions (37)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 1** - the key sits here more than its share.	**49%**	25%	18/37	**solid**
Among four numbers, keep the 2nd and 3rd largest; drop the extremes.	**73%**	50%	11/15	hint

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **option 3**	**14%**	25%	5/37	hint
Strike **the smallest number**	**7%**	25%	1/15	hint

When (year / date / period) questions (56)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the clearly shortest option.	**47%**	25%	9/19	**likely**

Where (place / location) questions (17)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 1** - the key sits here more than its share.	**47%**	25%	8/17	**likely**

How much (number / % / rank) questions (47)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 1** - the key sits here more than its share.	**36%**	25%	17/47	hint

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **option 4**	**11%**	25%	5/47	**likely** ✓

Scheme / policy / programme questions (51)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**36%**	25%	15/42	**likely** ✓

Which / what (other direct fact) questions (169)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**33%**	25%	42/127	**likely** ✓
Between two survivors, prefer **option 3** - the key sits here more than its share.	**30%**	25%	51/169	hint

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **option 4**	**15%**	25%	26/169	**solid**
Strike **shortest option**	**19%**	25%	23/122	hint

Unit by unit (syllabus units)

Andhra Pradesh Economy after Bifurcation (2014) AND the A.P. Reorganisation Act, 2014 - Economic Issues, Central Assistance, Special Status and the Controversy (147)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Among four numbers, keep the 2nd and 3rd largest; drop the extremes.	**62%**	50%	38/61	**likely**
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**34%**	25%	25/73	**likely**
Between two survivors, prefer **option 1** - the key sits here more than its share.	**30%**	25%	44/147	hint

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **the smallest number**	**16%**	25%	10/61	hint

Financial Institutions, RBI and Monetary Policy, Banking Reforms, NPAs, Financial Markets, SEBI, Indian Tax System, GST, Centre-State Financial Relations, Public Debt and Expenditure, Fiscal Policy and Budget (83)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 1** - the key sits here more than its share.	**32%**	25%	27/83	hint

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **option 2**	**16%**	25%	13/83	**likely**

Indian Agriculture, Irrigation, Inputs, Policy, Land Reforms, Credit, MSP, Food Security; Indian Industry, Industrial Policy, Make in India, SEZs, Energy; Economic Reforms; International Trade, BoP and WTO (96)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**36%**	25%	28/77	**likely**

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **shortest option**	**14%**	25%	8/59	**likely**
Strike **option 4**	**19%**	25%	18/96	hint

Keywords inside statements (any statement here is true 50%)

statement contains	true	count	read it as
only	33%	5/15	**suspect FALSE**
recently / launched	38%	3/8	**suspect FALSE**
largest / highest / most	45%	10/22	no signal
all	57%	8/14	no signal
a number (figure, year, %)	64%	79/124	no signal
not	65%	11/17	no signal
Andhra / AP	84%	16/19	**suspect TRUE**

6. Geography (India, World & AP) (613 keyed APPSC questions)

Across the subject

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
When two options are almost the same (one word differs), the key is one of those two - drop the other two.	**74%**	50%	25/34	**solid ✓**
Among four years, keep the middle two; drop the earliest and the latest.	**70%**	50%	14/20	hint
Pick the largest number.	**34%**	25%	22/65	hint

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **the smallest number**	**15%**	25%	10/65	**likely ✓**
Strike **the earliest year**	**10%**	25%	2/20	hint

NOT / INCORRECT / EXCEPT questions (60)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 4** - the key sits here more than its share.	**37%**	25%	22/60	**likely**

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **option 3**	**17%**	25%	10/60	hint

Statements (consider the following) questions (29)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 3** - the key sits here more than its share.	**38%**	25%	11/29	hint

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **shortest option**	**10%**	25%	2/20	hint

When (year / date / period) questions (22)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the clearly shortest option.	**50%**	25%	6/12	**likely ✓**

Where (place / location) questions (80)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 3** - the key sits here more than its share.	**32%**	25%	26/80	hint

How much (number / % / rank) questions (30)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the largest number.	**57%**	25%	8/14	**solid**
Between two survivors, prefer **option 1** - the key sits here more than its share.	**43%**	25%	13/30	**likely**
Pick the clearly shortest option.	**47%**	25%	7/15	hint

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **option 3**	**7%**	25%	2/30	**likely**
Strike **the smallest number**	**0%**	25%	0/14	**likely**

Superlative (first / largest / highest) questions (69)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**37%**	25%	18/49	**likely**

Which / what (other direct fact) questions (247)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
When two options are almost the same (one word differs), the key is one of those two - drop the other two.	**83%**	50%	10/12	**likely** ✓
Between two survivors, prefer **option 1** - the key sits here more than its share.	**30%**	25%	74/247	**likely**
Pick the largest number.	**38%**	25%	11/29	hint

Unit by unit (syllabus units)

Economic Geography of the World, India and Andhra Pradesh - Major Sectors, Agriculture, Industry and Services, Basic Industries, Transport and Trade (90)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 2** - the key sits here more than its share.	**33%**	25%	30/90	**likely**

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **option 4**	**18%**	25%	16/90	hint

General Geography - Earth in the Solar System, Motions, Time, Seasons, Interior of the Earth, Landforms, Atmosphere, Climate, Oceans, Hydrological Disasters, Marine and Continental Resources (195)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
When two options are almost the same (one word differs), the key is one of those two - drop the other two.	**83%**	50%	10/12	**likely**
Pick the one option that shares no word with the other three.	**50%**	25%	5/10	hint
Pick the largest number.	**44%**	25%	7/16	hint
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**30%**	25%	40/132	hint

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **the smallest number**	**6%**	25%	1/16	hint

Physical Geography of the World, India and Andhra Pradesh - Physical Divisions, Earthquakes, Landslides, Drainage, Climate and Monsoon, Vegetation, Parks and Sanctuaries, Soils, Rocks and Minerals (280)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 3** - the key sits here more than its share.	**31%**	25%	88/280	**solid**
Pick the largest number.	**48%**	25%	10/21	**likely**

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **option 4**	**18%**	25%	49/280	**solid**
Strike **the smallest number**	**10%**	25%	2/21	hint

Social Geography of the World, India and Andhra Pradesh - Distribution, Density, Growth, Sex Ratio, Literacy, Occupational Structure, SC/ST Population, Rural-Urban Components,

Racial/Tribal/Religious/Linguistic Groups, Urbanisation, Migration and Metropolitan Regions (48)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 1** - the key sits here more than its share.	**35%**	25%	17/48	hint

Micro-topics with a pattern of their own

Disaster management framework - hazard vs disaster, DM Act 2005, NDMA, early warning systems (57)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Among four years, keep the middle two; drop the earliest and the latest.	**75%**	50%	9/12	hint

Andhra Pradesh - drainage: Godavari, Krishna, Penna, Vamsadhara, Nagavali; reservoirs and canals (27)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the clearly shortest option.	**42%**	25%	8/19	hint

Keywords inside statements (any statement here is true 54%)

statement contains	true	count	read it as
not	21%	4/19	**suspect FALSE**
only	33%	4/12	**suspect FALSE**
a number (figure, year, %)	51%	22/43	no signal
largest / highest / most	55%	11/20	no signal
may / can	58%	7/12	no signal
Andhra / AP	69%	9/13	**suspect TRUE**

7. Science, Technology & Environment (441 keyed APPSC questions)

Across the subject

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**30%**	25%	95/313	**likely** ✓
When two options are almost the same (one word differs), the key is one of those two - drop the other two.	**64%**	50%	21/33	hint
Pick the option that shares most words with the other three - decoys are made by changing one part of the key.	**39%**	25%	9/23	**likely** ✓

NOT / INCORRECT / EXCEPT questions (46)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 4** - the key sits here more than its share.	**41%**	25%	19/46	**solid** ✓

Statements (consider the following) questions (32)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 3** - the key sits here more than its share.	**41%**	25%	13/32	**likely** ✓
Pick the clearly shortest option.	**44%**	25%	7/16	hint

Assertion-Reason questions (20)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**40%**	25%	8/20	**likely** ✓

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **option 4**	**5%**	25%	1/20	**likely** ✓

When (year / date / period) questions (28)

No trick beats chance here - rely on the fact.

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **option 4**	**11%**	25%	3/28	**likely** ✓

Where (place / location) questions (26)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**45%**	25%	9/20	**likely**
Between two survivors, prefer **option 2** - the key sits here more than its share.	**38%**	25%	10/26	hint

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **option 1**	**12%**	25%	3/26	hint

Scheme / policy / programme questions (29)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 3** - the key sits here more than its share.	**38%**	25%	11/29	hint

Definition / term / known as questions (22)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 1** - the key sits here more than its share.	**46%**	25%	10/22	**likely**

Superlative (first / largest / highest) questions (20)

No trick beats chance here - rely on the fact.

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **option 4**	**10%**	25%	2/20	**likely** ✓

Which / what (other direct fact) questions (183)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**35%**	25%	48/138	**solid** ✓
Between two survivors, prefer **option 1** - the key sits here more than its share.	**30%**	25%	55/183	hint
Pick the option that repeats the question's own words.	**46%**	25%	6/13	hint

Unit by unit (syllabus units)

Energy Requirement and Efficiency - India's Energy Needs and Deficit, Energy Resources and Dependence, Energy Policy, Government Policies and Programmes, Solar, Wind and Nuclear Energy (34)

No trick beats chance here - rely on the fact.

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **longest option**	**8%**	25%	2/26	**likely**

Environmental Science - Issues and Concerns, Legal Aspects and Treaties, Biodiversity, Climate Change, Forest and Wildlife, Pollution, Disaster Management, Biotechnology and Nanotechnology, Genetic Engineering, Health and Environment (232)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
When two options are almost the same (one word differs), the key is one of those two - drop the other two.	**77%**	50%	10/13	**likely**
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**31%**	25%	47/151	hint

Information and Communication Technology - Nature and Scope, ICT in Daily Life, ICT and Industry, ICT and Governance, Netiquettes, Cyber Security (36)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**38%**	25%	12/32	hint

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **option 2**	**14%**	25%	5/36	hint

Science and Technology - Nature and Scope, Relevance to Daily Life, National S&T Policy, Institutions and Prominent Indian Scientists (79)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**41%**	25%	26/63	**solid**
Pick 'Both'.	**85%**	56%	11/13	**likely**

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **option 4**	**15%**	25%	12/79	**likely**

Technology in Space and Defence - Indian Space Programme, ISRO, Satellite Programmes, IRNSS, IRS, Defence and Academic Satellites, DRDO (60)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 2** - the key sits here more than its share.	**38%**	25%	23/60	**likely**

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **option 3**	**17%**	25%	10/60	hint
Strike **option 4**	**17%**	25%	10/60	hint

Micro-topics with a pattern of their own

Relevance of science and technology to day-to-day life - health, food, transport, communication, household (49)

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Pick 'Both'.	**85%**	56%	11/13	**likely**
Pick the clearly longest option - here the examiner writes the right answer out in full and keeps decoys short.	**38%**	25%	15/40	hint

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **option 4**	**12%**	25%	6/49	**likely**

Keywords inside statements (any statement here is true 57%)

statement contains	true	count	read it as
all	31%	5/16	**suspect FALSE**
only	43%	6/14	no signal
not	43%	9/21	no signal
recently / launched	62%	8/13	no signal
a number (figure, year, %)	65%	52/80	no signal
first	82%	9/11	**suspect TRUE**
may / can	89%	24/27	**suspect TRUE**

8. Current Affairs (86 keyed APPSC questions)

Across the subject

Trick that works here	key	chance	count	trust
Between two survivors, prefer **option 2** - the key sits here more than its share.	**34%**	25%	29/86	**likely**

Reverse trick - rarely the key here	key	chance	count	trust
Strike **option 4**	**16%**	25%	14/86	**likely**

9. What does NOT work - folk tricks the keys disprove

- **"Avoid 'only' / 'all' / 'always'"** - in APPSC such statements are true about as often as any other; check the fact.
- **"When in doubt, C"** - option 3 is not favoured overall; the favoured position changes by subject and question kind (tables above).
- **"The answer is never the obvious one"** - APPSC keys the standard textbook answer; the straight code A-1 B-2 C-3 D-4 is used too.
- **"Pick one of the two closest numbers"** - no edge (48% against 50% chance).
- **Blind guessing** - zero expected gain with 1/3 negative marking.